SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #52 · RELIGIOUS UPBRINGING & TRAINING

“My worth depends on how much I serve.”

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Where it often comes from

Being praised mainly for being helpful or useful as a child. A church culture that celebrated the busiest volunteers. Feeling valuable only when needed. Trouble saying no. Guilt when resting or when others serve you.

What Scripture teaches

Your worth comes from God’s love, not your usefulness. God tells His people that they are precious and honored in His sight, and that He loves them. When Martha was busy serving and Mary sat at Jesus’ feet, Jesus said Mary had chosen the good portion. Service matters: we are created in Christ to do good works. But we serve because we are loved and valuable, not to become loved and valuable.

> *“Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life”* **(Isaiah 43:4)**.

Also see

> “‘Martha, Martha,’ the Lord replied, ‘you are worried and upset about many things. But only one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the good portion, and it will not be taken away from her.’” **(Luke 10:41–42)**.

> “For we are God’s workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life” **(Ephesians 2:10)**.

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light” **(Matthew 11:28–30)**.

> “And He said to them, ‘Come with Me privately to a solitary place, and let us rest for a while.’ For many people were coming and going, and they did not even have time to eat” **(Mark 6:31)**.

Common self-statements

- I’m only valuable when I’m helping.
- If I stop serving, no one will want me.
- I have to say yes to every request.
- Rest is selfish.
- God loves people who do more for Him.
- My busyness proves my faithfulness.

Common logical errors

- **Conditional worth:** Believing your value depends on what you do.
- **Should statements:** “I should always be available to serve.”
- **Labeling:** Calling yourself “useless” when you are not serving.
- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you must serve constantly or be worthless.

Challenging questions

- What does God say about my worth in Isaiah 43:4?
- Why did Jesus say Mary chose the better portion?
- Am I serving from love or from fear of being worthless?
- Did Jesus ever rest or tell His disciples to rest?
- Would I still be loved by God if I could never serve again?
- Who taught me that my worth comes from being useful?
- What would healthy service look like for me?

Truth summary

> My worth does not depend on how much I serve. I am precious and honored in God's sight because He loves me. Jesus values time with Him more than busyness for Him. I can serve out of love and gratitude, and I can also rest, say no, and let others serve me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Servant
- Love, By God
- Tired
- Self-Sacrifice

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who You Say I Am — Hillsong Worship
Our identity comes from being God's child, freely chosen and set free, not from what we produce.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
Sets God's view of us against the voices that say we are not enough.

Known — Tauren Wells
We are fully known and still fully loved, so there is nothing to earn.

Grace Got You — MercyMe
A joyful reminder that grace, not our effort or service, is what holds us and makes us God's.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My worth depends on how much I serve"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My worth depends on how much I serve." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does God say about my worth?
- ☐ Why did Mary choose the better portion?
- ☐ Am I serving from love or fear?
- ☐ Did Jesus rest and tell others to rest?
- ☐ Would God love me if I could never serve again?
- ☐ What does healthy service look like?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am precious and honored in God's sight.
- ☐ My worth comes from God's love, not my usefulness.
- ☐ Time with Jesus matters more than busyness for Him.
- ☐ I serve because I am loved, not to be loved.
- ☐ I can rest without guilt.
- ☐ Jesus' yoke is easy and His burden is light.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Isaiah 43:4**
  "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life."
- [ ] **Luke 10:41–42**
  "'Martha, Martha,' the Lord replied, 'you are worried and upset about many things. But only one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the good portion, and it will not be taken away from her.'"
- [ ] **Ephesians 2:10**
  "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life."
- [ ] **Matthew 11:28–30**
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light."
- [ ] **Mark 6:31**
  "And He said to them, 'Come with Me privately to a solitary place, and let us rest for a while.' For many people were coming and going, and they did not even have time to eat."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Listen to one song each day** from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Being, not doing:** Each day, write one way God showed He loves me that had nothing to do with what I did.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Isaiah 43:4 becomes: "Because **Sarah** is precious and honored in My sight, and because I love **her**, I will give men in exchange for **her** and nations in place of **her** life."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Say no to one request this week** kindly, and notice what actually happens.
- ☐ **Spend twenty minutes simply sitting with Jesus,** reading Scripture or praying, without a to-do list.
- ☐ **Let someone serve you** without arguing or paying them back.
- ☐ **Read Luke 10:38–42,** and write what Jesus valued most.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My worth depends on how much I serve": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One time I rested or said no
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My worth depends on how much I serve.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that I am precious and honored in Your sight because You love me. Help me reject the lie that my worth depends on how much I serve. Teach me to sit at Jesus' feet, to rest without guilt, and to serve out of love and gratitude. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.